Activity : 4

A 10 year old boy was admitted in the hospital with complaints of severe abdominal pain for the past three days and has pain during evacuation. He was passing hard and dark coloured stools.

- Identify the disease condition of the boy.
- Give the dietary guidelines for the boy

8.1.3 PEPTIC ULCER

Peptic ulcer is a term used to describe any localized erosion or necrosis of the mucosal lining that comes in contact with gastric juice. Mostly ulcer is formed in lower part of oesophagus (oesophageal ulcer), lesser curvature of the antrum of stomach (gastric ulcer) and first portion of duodenum (duodenal ulcer).

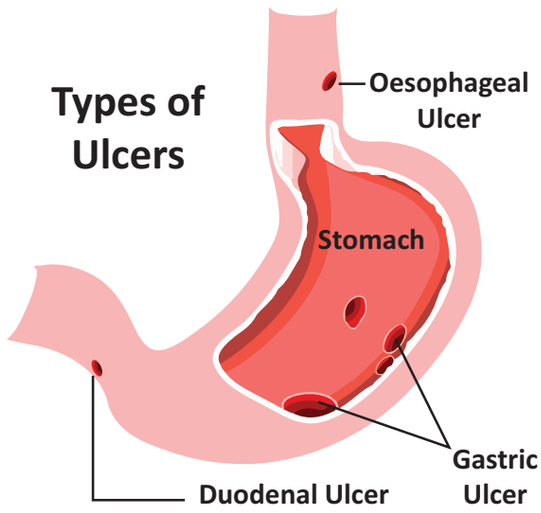


Fig 8.2 : Types of Ulcers

Causes of peptic ulcer

Over secretion of gastric juices is one of the direct causes of peptic ulcer disease. The other common causes are as follows :

a) Heredity: Peptic ulcer is not genetic disorder but patients with a family history of peptic ulcer have higher chances of developing the ulcers.

b) Helicobacter pylori infection: Chronic inflammation due to Helicobacter pylori is a major cause for gastric ulcers. The gastritis can stimulate hyper secretion of gastric juices causing erosion of the lining resulting in ulcers

c) Non-steroidal Anti - Inflammatory Drugs (NSAIDs): Excessive use of pain killers can cause ulcers. Prostaglandin protects the mucosal lining of the stomach. NSAIDs block and reduce the production of prostaglandins.

d) Excessive alcohol intake: Alcohol consumption increases risk with helicobacter pylori infection. Alcoholic beverages erode the protective stomach lining and lead to inflammation or bleeding.

e) Smoking and tobacco use: Nicotine and tobacco may increase the risk of developing ulcers.

f) Gender: Higher incidence of ulcers are seen in males than in females.

g) Dietary factors: Eating at irregular intervals, long gaps between each meal, high intake of spices, coffee or caffeine increases the risk of peptic ulcers.

h) Poor sanitation: Unsafe drinking water and Poor sanitation increases the risk of infection with Helicobacter pylori.

i) Stress and Anxiety: Emotional disturbances, fear, stress, worry and anxiety increases the chances for ulcers because of hypersecretion and hypermotility of the stomach.

Signs and symptoms of peptic ulcer

Ulcer may or may not give symptoms. A gastric ulcer may give epigastric pain during the meal. Duodenal ulcer pain may manifest after 2-3 hours of the meal. The symptoms also vary with the age of the patients.

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